

BONUS 2 OF 5

Illustrated Stitch Dictionary

Every stitch used in the patterns, with abbreviations, diagrams and step-by-step instructions.

Contents

1 • Foundation Stitches	3
2 • Basic Stitches	4
3 • Intermediate Stitches	6
4 • Textured Stitches	8
5 • Shaping Techniques	9
6 • Joining & Finishing	10
Quick Reference Chart	11
Next Step	12

SECTION 1

Foundation Stitches

The starting point for every pattern in this collection.

CH

Chain Stitch

The foundation of almost every crochet project. Creates the base row that all other stitches are worked into.



- Make a slip knot and place it on the hook
- Yarn over (wrap yarn around hook from back to front)
- Pull the yarn through the loop on the hook
- One chain made — repeat for the required number

SL ST

Slip Stitch

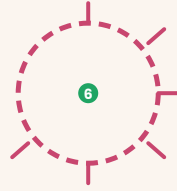
Used to join rounds, move across stitches without adding height, and create decorative surface lines.

- Insert hook into the stitch
- Yarn over and pull through both the stitch and the loop on the hook in one motion
- One slip stitch complete

MR

Magic Ring

Creates an adjustable loop to start working in the round — essential for backpack bases and circular pieces.



- Wrap yarn around two fingers to form a loop
- Insert hook, yarn over and pull up a loop
- Chain 1, then work the required stitches into the ring
- Pull the tail to close the ring — no hole in the center

SECTION 2

Basic Stitches

The workhorses of every backpack pattern — master these and you can make any design.

SC

Single Crochet

Short, tight stitch that creates a dense, sturdy fabric — ideal for backpack bodies.

- Insert hook into stitch
- Yarn over, pull up a loop (2 loops on hook)
- Yarn over, pull through both loops

HDC

Half Double Crochet

Slightly taller than SC with a softer drape — good for flaps and straps.

- Yarn over, insert hook into stitch
- Yarn over, pull up a loop (3 loops)
- Yarn over, pull through all 3 loops

DC

Double Crochet

Taller stitch with open texture — works up faster than SC, used in many adult designs.

- Yarn over, insert hook into stitch
- Yarn over, pull up a loop (3 loops)
- Yarn over, pull through 2 loops (2 remain)
- Yarn over, pull through last 2 loops

TR

Treble Crochet

The tallest basic stitch — creates a lacy, open fabric for mesh and decorative sections.

- Yarn over twice, insert hook
- Yarn over, pull up a loop (4 loops)
- Yarn over, pull through 2 — repeat twice more

BLO / FLO

Back Loop Only / Front Loop Only

Working into only one loop of the stitch creates a ridge — used for ribbed straps and textured panels.



- Identify the two loops at the top of each stitch (front = closest to you)
- For FLO: insert hook under the front loop only
- For BLO: insert hook under the back loop only
- Complete the stitch as normal

SECTION 3

Intermediate Stitches

Stitches that add texture and visual interest to your backpack designs.

PUFF

Puff Stitch

Multiple half-finished HDCs pulled together to create a puffy, rounded cluster — used in quilted-look designs.

- Yarn over, insert hook, pull up a loop — repeat 3–4 times in the same stitch (7–9 loops on hook)
- Yarn over and pull through all loops at once
- Chain 1 to lock the puff

BOBBLE

Bobble Stitch

Similar to puff but uses DC — creates a pronounced bump that pops out from the fabric surface.

- Work 4–5 DC in the same stitch, leaving the last loop of each unfinished (5–6 loops on hook)
- Yarn over and pull through all loops
- Push the bobble to the front (right side) of the work

FPDC

Front Post Double Crochet

Hook goes around the post from the front — creates raised ridges and cables.

- Yarn over, insert hook from front to back around the post of the stitch below
- Complete as a regular DC

BPDC

Back Post Double Crochet

Same as FPDC but from the back — pushes the stitch to the front for recessed lines.

- Yarn over, insert hook from back to front around the post
- Complete as a regular DC

SHELL

Shell Stitch

Multiple DC worked into the same stitch to create a fan shape — decorative and adds width quickly.

- Work 5 DC into the same stitch (or space)
- Skip 2 stitches on each side of the shell
- The 5 DC fan out to form a shell shape

V-ST

V-Stitch

DC, chain 1, DC in the same stitch — creates a V with a small gap. Used in mesh and openwork designs.

- DC into the stitch, chain 1, DC into the same stitch
- Skip 1–2 stitches before the next V-stitch

SECTION 4

Textured Stitches

Special combinations that add dimension, grip and visual variety.

BASKET

Basket Weave

Alternating blocks of FPDC and BPDC create a woven-look texture — structured and firm.

- Work blocks of 4 FPDC followed by 4 BPDC across the row
- Next row: work FPDC over the previous BPDC and vice versa
- Repeat to build the woven grid pattern

CABLE

Cable Stitch

Crossed FPDC stitches create a rope-like twist — the crochet version of knitted cables.

- Skip 2 stitches, FPDC into the next 2
- Go back and FPDC into the 2 skipped stitches, crossing in front
- The crossed posts create the cable twist
- Repeat every 4–6 rows for a visible cable

WAFFLE

Waffle Stitch

Alternating FPDC and BPDC in a shifted pattern creates a grid with depth — cushioned and warm.

- Row 1: DC across
- Row 2: *FPDC, BPDC* repeat across
- Row 3: *BPDC, FPDC* repeat (shifts columns)
- Repeat rows 2–3 for the waffle grid

GRANNY

Granny Square

Classic modular motif: clusters of DC separated by chains, worked in rounds. Join multiple squares for the Patchwork Granny backpack.

- MR, ch 3, 2 DC, *ch 2, 3 DC* 3 times, ch 2, sl st to top of ch-3
- Next round: 3 DC in each ch-2 corner space, with ch 2 between corner clusters
- Add 3 DC groups along each side as the square grows
- Continue until desired size, fasten off and join squares

SECTION 5

Shaping Techniques

How to increase, decrease and shape your pieces to form the backpack structure.

INC

Increase

Two stitches in the same stitch — makes the work wider or rounds bigger.

- Work one SC into the stitch
- Work another SC into the same stitch
- You now have 2 where there was 1

DEC

Decrease (Invisible)

Joins two stitches into one — narrows the work or closes the top of a round piece.

- Insert hook into front loop of first stitch
- Insert hook into front loop of next stitch
- Yarn over, pull through both, then through both loops on hook

CH SP

Chain Space

Chains between stitches create openings — used for drawstring channels, mesh panels and decorative holes.

- At the point where you want the space, chain 1–3 instead of working stitches
- Skip the same number of stitches in the row below
- Continue stitching after the gap
- For drawstrings: work a row of “SC, ch 1, skip 1” around the top

Counting stitches

Place a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round. Count your stitches at the end of each round — the number in parentheses (18) tells you exactly how many you should have.

SECTION 6

Joining & Finishing

How to put pieces together and finish your backpack with clean, professional edges.

WHIP

Whip Stitch Join

The simplest seam — quick and flat, good for joining straight edges like base to body.

- Hold pieces together with right sides facing
- Thread a yarn needle with matching yarn
- Insert through both layers, catching one loop from each
- Bring needle around and repeat evenly

SC JOIN

Single Crochet Join

Crocheting pieces together — creates a visible ridge that can be decorative. Stronger than whip stitch.

- Hold pieces together, insert hook through both layers
- Work SC through both pieces as if they were one
- Continue across the entire seam

FO

Fasten Off & Weave In

How to end your work securely so nothing unravels.

- Cut yarn leaving a 6-inch (15 cm) tail
- Pull the tail through the last loop on the hook
- Thread tail on a yarn needle
- Weave through 4–5 stitches on the wrong side, change direction, weave back
- Trim the excess close to the fabric

REFERENCE

Quick Reference Chart

All abbreviations and symbols at a glance.

ABBREVIATION	STITCH	HEIGHT	USED IN
ch	Chain	—	All patterns
sl st	Slip Stitch	0	Joining rounds
sc	Single Crochet	1 ch	Bodies, bases, straps
hdc	Half Double Crochet	2 ch	Flaps, transitions
dc	Double Crochet	3 ch	Panels, granny squares
tr	Treble Crochet	4 ch	Mesh, decorative
MR	Magic Ring	—	Circular starts
inc	Increase	—	Shaping rounds
dec	Decrease (invisible)	—	Closing, tapering
FLO / BLO	Front / Back Loop Only	—	Ribbing, texture
FPDC / BPDC	Front / Back Post DC	3 ch	Cables, basket weave
ch sp	Chain Space	—	Drawstring channels

Reading patterns in this collection

Every pattern uses these same abbreviations. When you see **sc 6**, it means “work 6 single crochet stitches.” When you see **(sc, inc) × 6**, it means “alternate 1 sc and 1 increase, 6 times around.” Stitch counts are shown in parentheses: **(18)**.

Next Step

Keep this dictionary handy while you work through any pattern. If a stitch feels unfamiliar, come back here, read the steps and try it on a small swatch before continuing your backpack.

The Crochet Backpack Collection